

The dog family



When you think of dogs, you probably think of pets, but many members of the dog family live in the wild.

Wolves

Wolves live in packs of about 20, which are led by a male and female. They are meat-eaters and all work together to hunt and kill. They can grow up to 1 m (3 ft) tall and have very sharp teeth, which are useful for tearing up meat.

European grey wolf

Wolves sometimes spray their urine to mark out their territory.



Wolf language

Facial expressions and body language are used by wolves within a pack to communicate with each other. When they want to keep other wolf packs away, they howl rather than bark.

Training the wolf

For thousands of years, people have trained dogs to do certain jobs.



Guide dogs: many dogs are used to guide blind people.



Sheep dogs: people have been using dogs to round up sheep for centuries.



Police dogs: these guard dogs use their noses to sniff out criminals.



At night, whole packs howl together to warn other wolves that they are there.